

A PROPOSAL FOR THE GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM

Assam's Workforce, Everywhere.

অসম আমাৰ ঘৰ। অসমীয়াৰ বাবে কাম আমাৰ লক্ষ্য।

Skill, support and place Assam's workers — wherever they are — and prepare its youth for the jobs now coming home.

Lakhs of young Assamese already power India's frontline. With the right skills, a verified profile and support through the journey, that migration becomes **an opportunity** — better jobs outside, and the skills to fill the jobs now arriving in Assam.

Prepared for Hon'ble Chief Minister Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma · Government of Assam

BetterPlace · verifyBetter · skillBetter · gigBetter · staffBetter · betterMoney

Assam's youth already power India's frontline. Today, unskilled and unseen.

Assam's people want to work — its labour-force participation is among India's highest. With too few local jobs, hundreds of thousands migrate for construction, plywood, hotels, security and factory floors across the country.

They leave as helpers, not skilled workers — and the state has no way to see, support or count them. Change that, and migration becomes an opportunity, not a loss.

66.9%

labour-force participation — among India's highest. People want work.

ACTUAL

PLFS 2023-24

4.26 L

workers returned to Assam during COVID — and even that is an undercount

FLOOR

ASSAM TRIBUNE

~8 L

Assamese estimated in Kerala alone — in construction & allied work

ESTIMATE

ASSAM TRIBUNE

21.16 L

registered educated job-seekers in Assam — qualified, but no local jobs

ACTUAL

ASSAM ECON. SURVEY, 2024

One state's youth, holding up others' economies.

Assamese workers are the backbone of construction, plywood, seafood and hospitality across India — usually as the lowest-paid, least-protected hands on site.

Kerala

~8 lakh Assamese (est.). Perumbavoor's plywood hub — 1.5 lakh+ migrants — runs on Assamese labour.

Tamil Nadu

Seafood & fish processing, SEZ and power-plant construction around Chennai & Ennore.

Karnataka & Delhi–NCR

Construction and hospitality. Assam is among Karnataka's top migrant-source states.

56.5%

of migrant construction workers are helpers — the bottom rung ACTUAL

KERALA SURVEY

23.5%

work as masons — a step up, still informal ACTUAL

KERALA SURVEY

~20%

hold a skilled role — most never get there ACTUAL

KERALA SURVEY

6

core sectors: construction, plywood, seafood, hotels, security, factories

They migrate on their own — unskilled, unverified, unsupported.

The gap isn't effort — Assam's workers work hard. The gap is that **no skills profile, no verification and no line of support travels with them**. So they start at the bottom, stay informal, and neither they nor the state can build on the journey.

- **No skills profile.** They arrive able to work, but with nothing to prove it — so they enter as helpers.
- **No verification.** No way to show a better employer they're trained, reliable and job-ready.
- **No support that travels.** Guidance, welfare and documents stay behind in Assam.

Give a worker skills, proof and support that travel with them — and the same migration lifts them up instead of holding them down.

0

databases of Assam's outbound workers — the state can't see or support who is where **REPORTED**

ASSAM TRIBUNE

72 L

Assam workers on e-Shram — but none tagged "migrant", so none can be reached **FLOOR**

E-SHRAM

Helper

the rung most Assamese enter at — and rarely leave without a certificate

ACTUAL

KERALA SURVEY

State-bound

welfare & benefits are registered at home; nothing follows the worker across the border

LABOUR DEPT

One certificate away from a better job.

Most Assamese migrants enter as helpers and stay there — not for lack of ability, but for lack of a certificate. Close that gap and wages, safety and formality follow.

- **Stuck at the bottom.** 81% of India's construction workforce is unskilled — the exact bracket Assamese enter as helpers.
- **Low wages, locked in.** Assam tea wages are ₹280/day — among India's lowest — pushing youth out into more of the same.
- **Welfare doesn't travel.** Benefits are state-registered; nothing follows a worker across the border.

A certificate is the difference between a helper and a skilled worker — and between invisible and insurable.

81%

of India's construction workers are unskilled — the helper trap ACTUAL

KNIGHT FRANK, 2023

₹280

a day — Assam tea-garden wage, among the lowest in India ACTUAL

2025

₹525 → 605

the wage ladder: unskilled → skilled. Certification is the classifier ACTUAL

STATUTORY WAGES, 2025

12 L+

work Assam's tea gardens — a young generation wants beyond plucking leaves ACTUAL

2025

And now — the jobs are finally coming to Assam.

Advantage Assam 2.0 loaded the **largest investment pipeline in the state's history** — and its jobs are overwhelmingly frontline: semiconductor assembly, plant construction, energy, logistics, hospitality.

For the first time, a young Assamese can build a career **without boarding a train to Kochi**. The state that skills its youth before the plants open keeps those jobs — and can call its people home.

Every MoU becomes a local job only if a verified, skilled Assamese worker is ready — in the right district, in the right month.

₹4.91 L Cr

committed at Advantage Assam 2.0 (Feb 2025) — the state's largest-ever pipeline **ACTUAL**

GOVT. OF ASSAM, 2025

₹27,000 Cr

Tata Electronics semiconductor plant at Jagiroad — anchor of the wave **ACTUAL**

TATA ELECTRONICS, 2025

~27 K

direct + indirect jobs projected from the Jagiroad plant alone **PROJECTION**

MEDIA-REPORTED

6

frontline engines: chips, energy, logistics, tourism, agro & q-commerce **ACTUAL**

ADVANTAGE ASSAM 2.0

Build the jobs at home. But protect our people already out there.

Our aim is to ensure that the children of Assam do not have to leave their families and go outside the State for work.

— Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma, Chief Minister of Assam

Atmanirbhar Asom is the right long game. But hundreds of thousands are **already outside today**. We don't wait for the plants to open — we skill and support Assam's workers wherever they are, right now, and prepare them for the jobs coming home.

1 Support now

Verify every worker, and carry skills, welfare & a helpline across state lines — so the journey is supported, not left to chance.

2 Upgrade now

Upskill helpers into certified, better-paid, insurable jobs — in their own language, on their own phone.

3 Bring home later

Feed skilled, experienced Assamese back into Jagiroad, the refineries and the logistics parks the ₹4.91L Cr pipeline is building.

The same worker, three ways to win.

Migration isn't a problem to end — it's an opportunity to organise. One skilled, verified Assamese worker opens *three markets at once*.

1 Within Assam

The **₹4.91L Cr Advantage Assam 2.0** wave — Jagiroad semiconductors, refineries, logistics, tourism, retail & green energy. Skill youth now to fill these jobs first.

2 Across India

Move helpers up to **skilled, verified** roles in the states where Assamese already work — construction, e-commerce, warehousing, customer support — from ₹525 to ₹605+/day.

3 Overseas

The **CM Flight Scheme** — language- and skill-ready Assamese placed in Japan, the GCC and beyond, sending higher wages home.

One verified profile unlocks all three — and every placement, anywhere, feeds the state's own talent pool.

One Assamese worker. One verified profile. Everywhere they go.

An **Assam Worker Stack** — a verified, portable, lifelong profile that follows every Assamese worker across India, carrying their identity, welfare and skills. The state's living record of its people, wherever they work.

- 01 **Assam owns the data.** We run the engine. The registry and control stay with the state.
- 02 **It travels with the worker.** Identity, welfare and skills move across every border — one profile, for life.
- 03 **Support from day one.** The state can see, skill and support a worker from the moment they register — not only react later.

Formalise the migrant workforce the way UPI formalised payments — trusted, verified, built for scale.

SERVES

CM Dashboard

REAL-TIME

The Worker

ONE PROFILE

Employers

VERIFIED

Welfare Boards

PORTABLE



**Assam Worker ·
Verified**

Portable · lifelong

✓ VERIFIED

✓ Identity & skills — **certified**

✓ Welfare & insurance — **linked, portable**

PORTABLE RECORD

ASSAM WORKER STACK

FED AUTOMATICALLY BY

e-Shram

EPFO

ESIC

ASDM

Labour Dept

Orunodoi

Reach. Verify. Protect. Upskill. Uplift.

We don't hand the state a portal. We run the full loop — and hand back workers who are seen, protected and moving up.



🔗 EVERY WORKER SEEN, PROTECTED AND UPGRADED — AND COUNTED ON THE CM'S DASHBOARD 🔗

— THE ASOM KAAM APP • IN BUILD

One app. Every Assamese worker. In their own language.



A single app that **verifies** a worker, **protects** them across state lines, **upskills** them and **matches** them to safe, better-paid jobs — in Assamese, on any phone.



Verified & supported

One worker ID, insurance & a 24×7 helpline that travel across every border.



Upskill to earn more

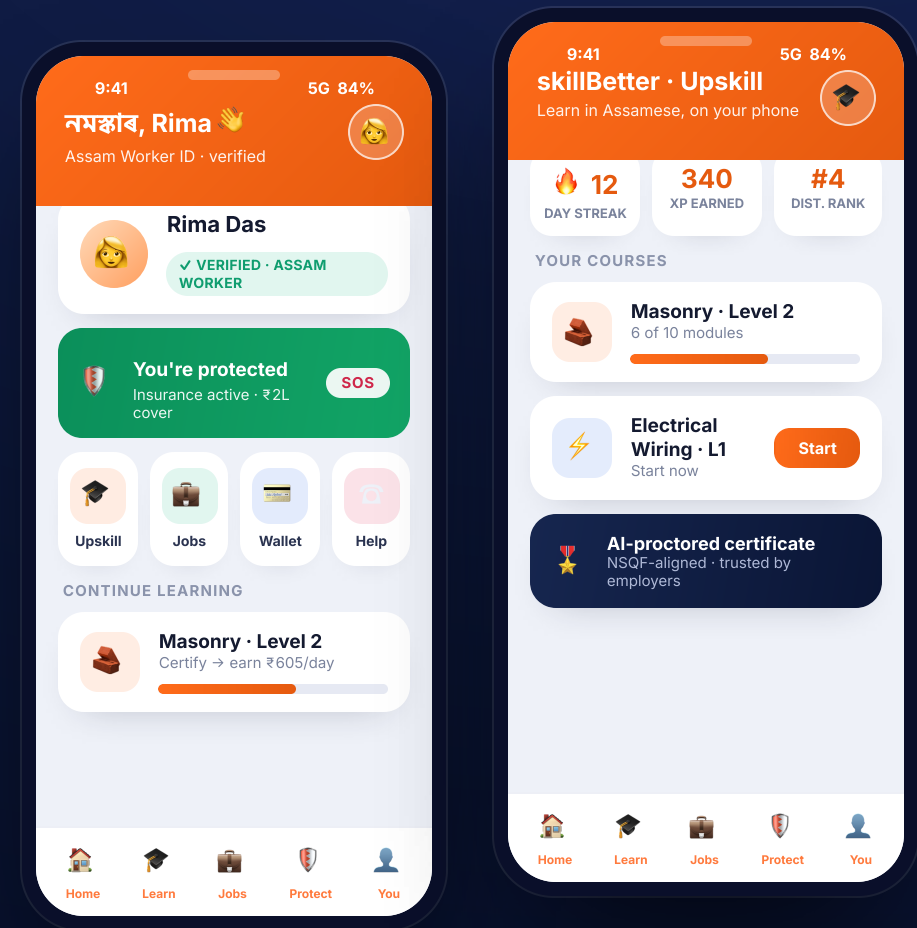
Assamese-first courses on the proven skillBetter engine.



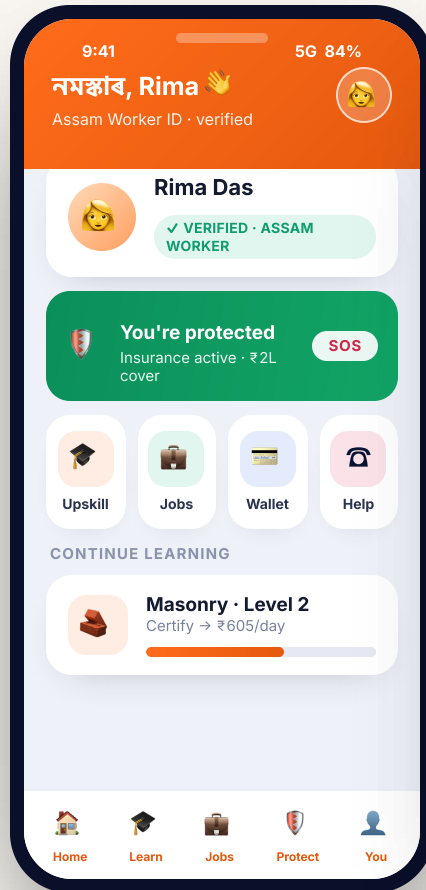
Jobs that find them

Matched to verified employers — near home, or on the way back.

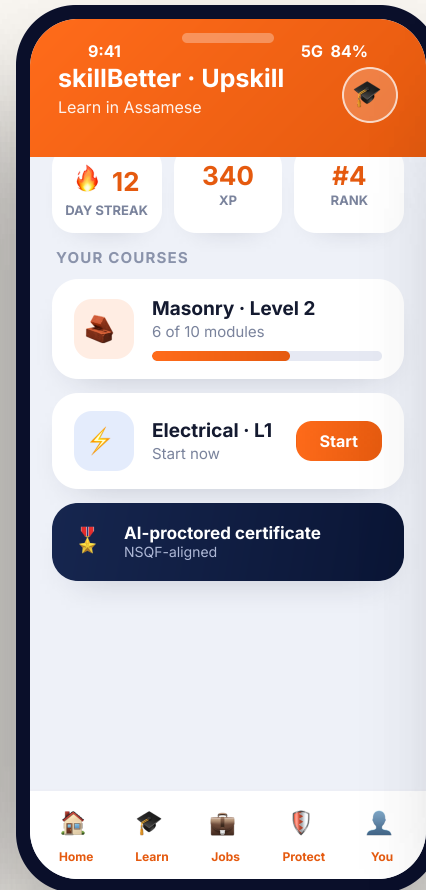
Built on skillBetter — live today, 2.5M+ workers skilled. Assam edition designed for Assamese workers.



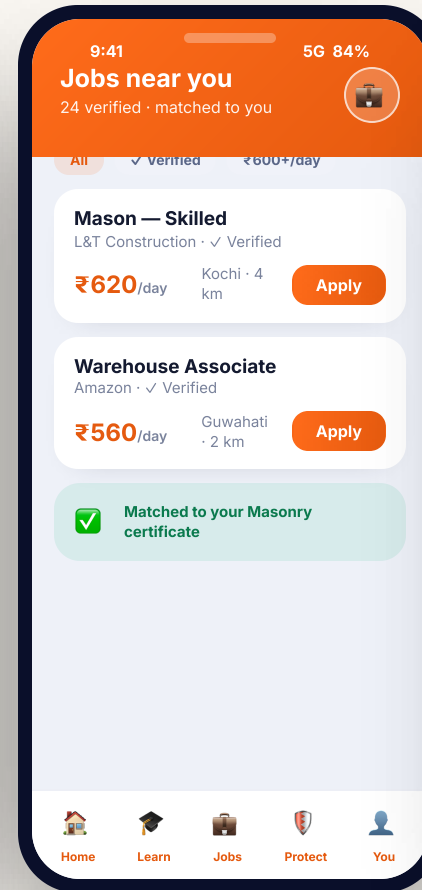
Four taps from invisible to verified, skilled and safe.



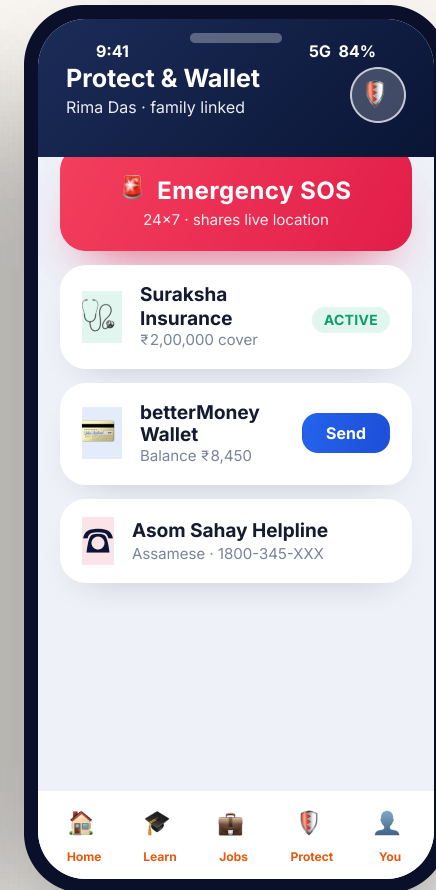
Verified profile & protection
ONE WORKER ID



Upskill in Assamese
SKILLBETTER ENGINE



Safe, verified jobs
MATCHED TO SKILLS



Insurance, helpline & wallet
WELFARE THAT TRAVELS

Support that travels with the worker.

Skills alone aren't enough. A migrating worker needs benefits, money and someone to call that move with them — so the journey is supported end to end, not left to chance.

◆ Portable welfare & insurance

Social security that crosses state borders — accident & health cover from day one, benefits that don't reset when a worker moves.

◆ Financial inclusion

Bank-linked wages, savings, easy remittance home and early-wage access — so families are supported, not indebted (betterMoney).

◆ A helpline in their language

Verified employers and an Assamese grievance line — so a worker always has someone to call, and a fake job can be flagged early.

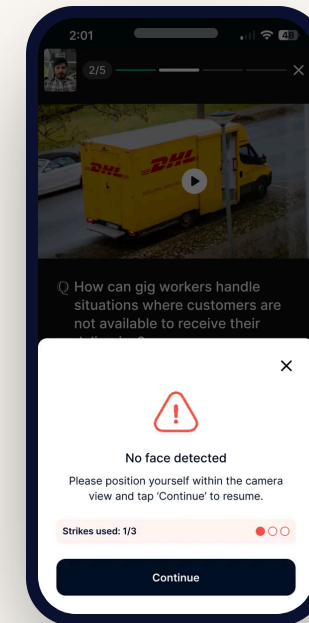
◆ Guidance, before & after placement

Pre-departure orientation, documents in order and regular check-ins — support that doesn't stop at the certificate.

From helper to skilled — in their own language.

Mobile-first, Assamese-first training that turns an unskilled helper into a **certified, higher-paid, insurable** worker — and opens the door to formal jobs.

- **The ladder:** helper ₹525 → skilled ₹605+ a day. Certification is what moves them up.
- **The tracks:** masonry, electrical, welding, plumbing, security (PSARA), hospitality, driving & delivery.
- **Global-ready:** language & skills for the CM's Flight Scheme — Assamese youth placed abroad.



CERTIFY ON A LOW-COST PHONE • LIVE IN THE SKILLBETTER APP

The plants are coming. Skill for them the right way.

India's experience is consistent — state skilling built **without live employer demand** produces certificates, not jobs. Karnataka's own audit found just **18% of trainees placed against a 70% target**, courses chosen without vacancy evidence.

Assam can leapfrog that mistake: wire skilling to the **named, dated demand** of Jagiroad, the refineries and the logistics parks — before they switch on.

BetterPlace's model is the inversion: demand first, placement verified, paid on outcomes.

Role-level demand mapping

Cleanroom & assembly operators, industrial electricians, welders, warehouse associates, hospitality staff — the exact roles the pipeline hires, mapped district by district.

Women-first pipelines

Electronics assembly is a proven women's-employment engine across Asia. Assam can design women-first tracks into Jagiroad from day one.

Timing is everything

Skilling has a lead time. Plants hiring in 12–24 months need sourcing & training **started now**.

We're already where Assam works.

Kochi, Chennai, Bengaluru, Delhi — the exact cities Assamese migrate to. We don't have to find them from Guwahati. We're already there.

500+

cities live across India & SE Asia — the destinations, not just the source

30M+

frontline workers on the platform

COMPANY

2.5M+

workers skilled to date

COMPANY

Asom-first

AI in Assamese, on a low-cost phone

◆ The reach to find them

An on-ground network in the very cities Assamese work — so a worker in Perumbavoor or Ennore is one we can already reach, verify and protect.

◆ The data to place them

The largest verified frontline workforce dataset in Asia — matching skilled Assamese to safer, better-paid, formal employers.

Four things Assam wants — delivered on one platform.

Beyond training numbers: the skills local industry needs, jobs funded wherever Assamese work, a digital footprint that earns visibility, and measurable value for every rupee.

1 Skills for local jobs

ASDM & ITI courses mapped to Advantage Assam 2.0 and Jagiroad demand — so the incoming plants hire skilled Assamese first.

2 Jobs funded, everywhere

A placement-linked model that funds verified jobs for Assamese across the country — and abroad via the CM Flight Scheme — not only inside the state.

3 A digital footprint & mileage

A state-branded app, a live CM dashboard and steady success stories — making the government's work visible to citizens and industry.

4 Value for every rupee

Outcome-linked commercials: the state pays for candidates **certified, verified and placed** — not for enrolment.

This is the engine under the goals you've already announced — Atmanirbhar Asom, the Flight Scheme, and a real answer to the 15.4 lakh registered jobseekers.

Start with one corridor. Prove it in 90 days.

A migration-corridor pilot that proves protection, upskilling and the live dashboard before any statewide rollout.

THE 90-DAY PILOT

One corridor + one source district — the Assam→Kerala construction & plywood belt (Perumbavoor), plus a tea-belt district at home.

Register, verify, upskill & place a first cohort — with welfare, insurance and a helpline live from day one.

First cut of the CM dashboard — a live map of who is where, skilled and placed.

PHASE 1 • 0-6 MO

Corridor Pilot

One corridor + one district live · dashboard stood up.

PHASE 2 • 6-18 MO

Top Corridors

Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka corridors · Assam Worker ID statewide.

PHASE 3 • 18-36 MO

Every Worker Seen

Full stack · real-time CM dashboard · pathway-home placements.

WHAT WE ASK

Policy sponsorship

Endorsement under ASDM & the Labour & Welfare department.

Data & platform access

Linkage to e-Shram, ASDM & the state welfare boards.

A joint working group

With Labour, Skill Development & Employment, convened within **30 days**.

Priced on outcomes. Built for 2 lakh.

A simple, milestone-linked model — a fixed fee to **skill & certify** each worker, and a **placement fee paid only when a verified job is confirmed**. Ready for the corridor projects and jobs across India & abroad.

COMPONENT	VOLUME	RATE	TOTAL
Skill & certify training, NSQF certificate + verified digital identity	2,00,000	₹5,000	₹100 Cr
Place in a job 20% placement target · paid only on verified placement	40,000	₹7,000	₹28 Cr
Total programme			₹128 Cr

≈ ₹130 Cr all-in. The state pays for outcomes, not enrolment — placement is billed only on a verified job. Optional employer & CSR co-funding can offset further.

2L

workers skilled & certified — ready for the corridor projects, jobs across India & overseas

40 K

verified placements — 20% target, paid on the outcome

TARGET

₹5,000

all-in skilling fee — training, assessment, certificate, digital identity & registry

A live map of every Assamese worker in India.

Seen

every outbound worker registered & verified — the data gap, closed

Supported

portable welfare, insurance & a helpline that cross borders

Upgraded

helpers certified into higher-paid, formal jobs

1

real-time dashboard — who is where, skilled and placed

Targets, not promises — scaled from the corridor pilot. Every worker verified and counted on the CM's dashboard.

Assam becomes the first state that can see, skill and uplift its workers — wherever in India they are — and staff the jobs now coming home.

Let Assam lead India in how it skills and places its workforce.

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We're asking for your endorsement, and for **BetterPlace as Assam's delivery partner** — starting with a 90-day corridor pilot: skills for local jobs, jobs funded wherever Assamese work, a digital footprint that earns mileage, and commercials paid on outcomes.

What we'd like to walk out with

01 Endorsement of the vision & BetterPlace as execution partner

02 A committed 90-day corridor pilot

03 A joint working group convened within 30 days

The evidence behind this proposal.

- 1 **Out-migration scale** — ~72 lakh unorganised workers on e-Shram (a floor; not migrant-tagged); 4.26 lakh returned during COVID; ~8 lakh Assamese estimated in Kerala. Assam Tribune; Sentinel Assam.
- 2 **Job categories & skill split** — Kerala construction: 56.5% helpers, 23.5% masons, ~20% skilled (survey). Perumbavoor plywood hub (1.5 lakh+ migrants) runs on Assamese labour. Core destination sectors: construction, plywood, seafood, hospitality, security, factories. IJSSHR; Deccan Herald.
- 3 **Assam labour market** — LFPR 66.9% (PLFS 2023–24); 21.16 lakh registered educated job-seekers (2024); 15.4 lakh registered unemployed (Jun 2026); dept. admits no in-state placement scheme. Assam Econ. Survey; Sentinel Assam.
- 4 **The wage ladder** — 81% of India's construction workforce unskilled (Knight Frank, 2023); Assam tea wage ₹280/day; statutory wage ladder ₹525→₹605 with certification.
- 5 **The investment wave** — Advantage Assam 2.0 (Feb 2025): ₹4.91 lakh Cr of commitments; Tata Electronics ₹27,000 Cr semiconductor OSAT at Jagiroad (~27,000 direct+indirect jobs projected, media-reported). Govt. of Assam; Tata Electronics.
- 6 **Local skilling sectors & NSQF roles** — retail, e-commerce, green energy, customer support, IT-ITeS, mining, media & marketing, tourism, apparel & handicrafts — all mapped to Sector Skill Council QP/NOS standards.
- 7 **The skilling lesson** — Karnataka CAG Report No. 6 of 2025 (CMKKY): 18% placement vs 70% target — the national case for demand-first skilling.
- 8 **Schemes to build on** — ASDM, Assam Skill University (Mangaldai), Orunodoi, CM's Atmanirbhar Asom self-employment scheme, CM Flight Scheme (global placement).
- 9 **Commercials basis** — indicative unit economics (₹5,000 blended per certified candidate; ₹12,000 per verified placement) adapted from BetterPlace's prior PMKVY 4.0 Special Project costing; to be finalised with the state.
- 10 **BetterPlace company figures** — present in 500+ cities; 30M+ workers, 2.5M+ skilled. Company-reported.

Migration "scale" figures are estimates or administrative floors — Assam keeps no census of its outbound workers. Commercials are indicative and to be finalised with the state. Company figures are company-reported. Outcome figures are targets.